

tion. This could be needed in a server machine, where, on restart, the boot partition gets restored automatically. So if the server behaves crankily, you just need to restart the machine—the machine will reach a stable point, and continue normal operation from there on.

An important point is that RestoreIT took more than twice the time taken by other software in this category, for a restore.

If you want to rollback to a certain period you can do so reasonably easily with Restore-IT, but in case of a disaster like a lost MBR, you're stranded.

- + Messing up with backup data is less likely

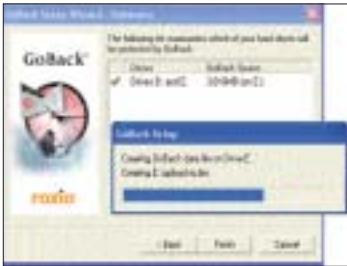
- Very slow

Restore IT	
Performance	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Features	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Ease of use	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Overall	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮

GoBack 3.0

Recover files with virtual drives

At installation, GoBack consumes approximately 10 per cent of the disk space, in any partition that has enough free space. In our case, the hard disk was a 4 GB one, and GoBack created a gobackio.bin file of about 411 MB. This file is used to store an image of the hard disk at System Safe Points. By hard disk is meant the entire disk—this software does not allow you to monitor just a single partition of a drive. Though partition-wise monitoring is not supported, there is a file recovery facility.



GoBack backs up your drive during installation

To recover individual files, there's a unique feature called 'Create GoBack Drive.' This creates a set of virtual drives. If you have three partitions—C, D and E—when you choose 'Create GoBack Drive,' three virtual drives, F, G and H, are created. These give you access to all the files at that particular System Safe Point. You can create these

drives for any System Safe Point.

This software does not allow the user too much freedom. It creates safe points whenever it detects activities such as an application install, a file modification, and so on. GoBack has a feature called Auto Revert, which is similar to that of RestoreIT. It also has a feature to disable itself. However, if you disable GoBack, all previous System Safe Points are erased.

This software is very similar to RestoreIT, except for the virtual drive feature—which makes it the better of the two.

- + Very Fast, utilises 10 per cent space of total hard disk size

- Monitors entire drive

GoBack 3.0	
Performance	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Features	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Ease of use	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮
Overall	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮

Conclusion

In terms of function, both software come into action before the OS does, and can be used to revert the system. But if faster is better, GoBack is the winner. It also features a near one-touch revert option. Even if not the best, it's certainly better than RestoreIT.

CATEGORY	ROLLBACK SOFTWARE	
Product	FarStone RestoreIT	Symantec GoBack
Ease of Use	15.75	21
Installation (Scale of 5)	3.5	4
Configuration (Scale of 5)	3.5	4
Interface (Scale of 5)	3.5	3
Updating (Scale of 5)	0	3
Features	12.86	12.86
Backup on removable media	✗	✗
Backup on network drive	✗	✗
Drive-wise	✓	✓
Partition-wise	✓	✗
Individual file extraction	✗	✓
Restore to alternate location	✗	✗
Scheduling	✓	✓
Performance	2.08	23.84
Backup Time (seconds)	801	47
Restore Time (seconds)	867	85
Compression (%)	66	19
Total	30.68	57.70
Web site	www.farstone.com	www.goback.com

BACKUP SOFTWARE

We looked at some backup tools for home and SoHo users. Apart from folder-to-folder backup, most utilities also support backup across a network, which would be needed in an office environment. In all, we tested four software in this section—Second Copy 2000, WinBackup, Save-N-Sync v3.0 and AutoBackup.

Second Copy 2000

Make a second copy

Second Copy is a small backup utility, not a full-fledged backup-and-restore software. It can just copy data to a specified alternative location. If you lose a file, you'll need to manually extract the file from the alternative location—it acts as a one way process.

Configuring the software consists of creating profiles, which store the source and destination paths as well as the type, time and interval of backup desired. The interval can be every few min-



Second Copy 2000 lets you choose the type of backup for each profile

Wipe out that Data

The realisation that data cannot be completely deleted has spawned a large industry that makes money by helping corporates delete sensitive data. The basic idea is to overwrite the specific file to be deleted multiple times with garbage data, thereby rendering the file illegible. There are lots of freeware and shareware utilities available for this purpose, such as Ultra Wipe and SysShield File Shredder. In extreme cases, companies use special equipment to 'degauss' the hard drive—a procedure that removes all magnetic properties associated with the hard disk.